



MONEY YOU'RE OWED

# Money You're Owed Master Tracker

CLAIM WHAT'S RIGHTFULLY YOURS

**The official process is always free.** This kit doesn't sell you secrets — it's the done-for-you implementation: fill-in letters, word-for-word scripts, and trackers that save you the hours. Every method is built on official 2026 U.S. rules (DOT, IRS, CFPB, FDIC, state programs).

# Money You're Owed — Master Tracker

The hub that organizes every dollar you're chasing — in one place.

**Money You're Owed** — *the official process is always free. Never pay a finder.*

**One-line promise:** One tracker that holds every claim — unclaimed property, refunds, fee reversals, tax credits, warranties — with the official free link, the deadline, and the next action for each, so nothing slips and no dollar gets left behind.

**This is implementation, not information.** Every dollar this tracker helps you recover can be claimed for **free** through an official government or company channel. We never charge you to access a right, and neither should anyone else. What you're paying for here is the *done-for-you system* — the structure, the formulas, the verified free links, and the setup steps — so you spend your time claiming money instead of building a spreadsheet. If any website asks for a percentage of "your" money to "find" or "release" it, close the tab. The links in this tracker route you to the real, free source every time.

## What's in this product

| File                          | What it is                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00-PRODUCT.md                 | This file — title page, table of contents, how to use, the master column spec                                      |
| 01-master-tracker-template.md | The full master table (Markdown) with every section + example rows, ready to copy into Notion or paste into Sheets |
| 02-master-tracker.csv         | The <b>importable</b> version — drop straight into Google Sheets, Excel, or Notion                                 |
| 03-setup-google-sheets.md     | Step-by-step: build the tracker + the "Money Recovered" dashboard in Google Sheets (with the exact formulas)       |
| 04-setup-notion.md            | Step-by-step: build the same tracker as a Notion database with rollups and per-section views                       |
| 05-official-free-links.md     | The verified free official source for every category — the never-pay-a-finder link list                            |
| 06-dashboard-and-formulas.md  | The "Money Recovered" dashboard concept + copy-paste formulas (totals, recovery rate, deadline alerts)             |

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## How this tracker works

You're owed money in more than one place. A forgotten deposit sitting with your state. A refund an airline never processed. A hospital bill with a charge that shouldn't be there. A subscription you canceled that kept billing. A tax credit you qualified for but never claimed.

Each one has its **own** official free process — but chasing them one at a time, in your head, is how they get forgotten. This tracker is the **spine**. Every claim lives as one row. Each row tells you: how much is at stake, how much you've recovered, which law backs it, the official free link to start, what status it's in, when the deadline is, and the single next action.

When the other four products in the "Money You're Owed" set generate a letter, a script, or a complaint — you log the result here. This is mission control.

## The seven sections

The tracker is split into seven sections (tabs in Sheets, or filtered views in Notion). Use one, use all seven:

| # | Section                   | What goes here                                                                                                        |
|---|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Unclaimed property        | Forgotten bank accounts, uncashed checks, security deposits, insurance payouts, paychecks, refunds held by your state |
| 2 | Airline / travel refunds  | Canceled or significantly delayed flights, delayed bags, paid-for services not provided, hotel/OTA refunds            |
| 3 | Medical bill disputes     | Itemized-bill requests, duplicate/erroneous charges, balance billing, surprise out-of-network bills                   |
| 4 | Bank & card fee reversals | Overdraft/NSF fees, unauthorized charges, double charges, undelivered goods disputed on the card                      |
| 5 | Subscriptions             | Charges after cancellation, free trials that converted without notice, zombie subscriptions                           |
| 6 | Tax credits               | Unclaimed EITC, Child Tax Credit, Saver's Credit, education credits, unfiled-year refunds                             |
| 7 | Warranty / lemon          | Product warranty claims, repeated repairs, lemon-law vehicles, refused warranty service                               |

## The master column spec

Every row in every section uses the **same ten columns**. Same spine everywhere — that's what lets one dashboard total it all.

| Column             | What to put in it                                                              | Example                                     |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| category           | Which of the seven sections this row belongs to                                | Airline / travel refunds                    |
| item               | Plain description of the specific claim                                        | Delta DL482 cancelled 3/14 – never refunded |
| potential \$       | Your best estimate of what you're owed (a number, no \$ sign so formulas work) | 412.00                                      |
| recovered \$       | What you've actually gotten back so far (starts at 0)                          | 0                                           |
| law / source       | The law or rule that backs the claim                                           | DOT 14 CFR Part 260 – automatic refund      |
| official free link | The real, free official place to start (from 05-official-free-links.md)        | secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint         |
| status             | Where this claim is in the flow (see below)                                    | Filed                                       |
| deadline           | The date you must act by, if any (YYYY-MM-DD)                                  | 2026-09-12                                  |
| next action        | The one next thing YOU do                                                      | If no refund in 7 days, file DOT complaint  |
| date               | Date of the last update to this row                                            | 2026-06-10                                  |

**Why potential \$ and recovered \$ have no dollar sign or commas:** so your spreadsheet treats them as numbers and the dashboard can add them up. Format the *display* as currency in Sheets/Notion — keep the *stored value* a plain number.

## The status flow

Use these exact words in the **status** column. They drive the dashboard counts and the color coding.

| Status               | Meaning                                                                           |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| To do                | Identified, not started                                                           |
| Researching          | Confirming you're owed it / gathering account numbers, dates, amounts             |
| Filed                | Letter sent / claim submitted / complaint filed — waiting on them                 |
| Escalated            | They said no or went silent; you've pushed to the regulator / next level          |
| Recovered            | Money received. Put the amount in <b>recovered \$</b> and the date in <b>date</b> |
| Closed – no recovery | Dead end, not owed, or not worth the time. Keeps your "open" list honest          |

**Rule:** a row is never just "done." It's either Recovered (with a dollar amount) or Closed – no recovery. That discipline is what makes the dashboard's recovery rate meaningful.

## How to use it day to day

1. **Brain-dump first.** Add a row for every claim you can think of, even vague ones. Status To do. Don't worry about exact amounts yet.
2. **Run the free searches.** Start with the two that cost nothing and take five minutes: unclaimed property (MissingMoney.com) and your IRS refund status (irs.gov/refunds). Log what you find.

3. **Work top-down by deadline.** Sort by the **deadline** column. The ones with the nearest dates move first — refunds and tax windows expire.
  4. **One next action per row.** The **next action** column should always answer "what do I do next?" — not "waiting." If you're waiting, the next action is the follow-up and the date you'll do it.
  5. **Log the result the day it happens.** Money in → status **Recovered**, fill **recovered \$**, update **date**. This is the part people skip; it's the part that pays.
  6. **Check the dashboard weekly.** Running total recovered, total still open, and anything with a deadline inside 14 days.
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## Where to go next

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- Build it: open `03-setup-google-sheets.md` or `04-setup-notion.md` and follow the steps.
- Import the ready-made file: `02-master-tracker.csv`.
- Get the free links: `05-official-free-links.md`.
- Wire up the dashboard: `06-dashboard-and-formulas.md`.

Everything in this product points to a **free** official process. The tracker saves you time. It never sells you a right.

## 01 — Master Tracker Template (Markdown)

**When/how to use this:** This is the full tracker in Markdown form. Copy any section's table straight into a Notion page (paste as a table) or use the .csv (02-master-tracker.csv) for Google Sheets / Excel. Every section uses the **same ten columns** so one dashboard can total all of them.

**What backs it:** Each section's law / source column names the real federal rule or official program. The official free link column always routes to a free government or first-party channel — never a paid finder. Full link list and citations in 05-official-free-links.md.

The example rows are illustrations of how to fill the tracker. Delete them and enter your own. Keep potential \$ and recovered \$ as **plain numbers** (no \$, no commas) so formulas work.

### Section 1 — Unclaimed property

| category           | item                                                    | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                    | official free link      | status | deadline | next action                                                           | date       |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Unclaimed property | Old checking account, First Regional Bank, closed ~2018 | 240.00       | 0            | State unclaimed property act (escheat) — held in trust for owner, no expiration | missingmoney.com        | To do  |          | Search MissingMoney by full name + maiden name + every state lived in | 2026-06-10 |
| Unclaimed property | Uncashed final paycheck, prior employer                 | 0            | 0            | State unclaimed property act                                                    | unclaimed.org/search    | To do  |          | Search NAUPA; also search by former employer name                     | 2026-06-10 |
| Unclaimed property | CA-held funds (lived in LA 2015–2019)                   | 0            | 0            | CA Unclaimed Property Law                                                       | sco.ca.gov/upd_msg.html | To do  |          | CA not on MissingMoney — search CA Controller site directly           | 2026-06-10 |

**Note:** Unclaimed property never expires — the state holds it in trust until you claim it. There is **no deadline** to claim, which is why that column stays blank here. CA, NY, and PA are not fully on MissingMoney.com; search those state sites directly.

### Section 2 — Airline / travel refunds

| category                 | item                                             | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                                                                        | official free link                  | status | deadline | next action                                                            | date       |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Airline / travel refunds | Flight cancelled, airline only offered a voucher | 412.00       | 0            | DOT automatic refund rule, 14 CFR Part 260 — cash refund owed when flight cancelled/significantly changed and you decline rebooking | secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint | To do  |          | Request cash refund in writing first; refund due to card within 7 days | 2026-06-10 |
| Airline / travel refunds | 3+ hour domestic delay, didn't fly               | 0            | 0            | DOT rule: 3-hr domestic / 6-hr intl delay = "significant change" → refund if you decline travel                                     | transportation.gov/airconsumer      | To do  |          | Confirm delay length; request refund; file DOT complaint if denied     | 2026-06-10 |
| Airline / travel refunds | Checked bag delayed >12 hrs, paid bag fee        | 35.00        | 0            | DOT rule — bag fee refund for significantly delayed checked bag                                                                     | secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint | To do  |          | Request bag-fee refund with claim/PNR number                           | 2026-06-10 |

**Note:** Refunds must be **automatic, prompt, in the original form of payment, and the full amount** — within 7 business days for credit-card purchases, 20 calendar days for cash/check. If the airline stalls, file the free DOT complaint; airlines must acknowledge a DOT consumer complaint within 30 days and send a substantive response within 60 days (14 CFR 259.7).

## Section 3 — Medical bill disputes

| category              | item                                                                     | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                                                                                                                                     | official free link                                                | status | deadline | next action                                                  | date       |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Medical bill disputes | Hospital bill, no itemization, suspect duplicate charges                 | 1,840.00     | 0            | Request an itemized bill (right varies by state / payer rules / hospital policy — there is no single universal federal itemized-bill law); review for duplicate, never-rendered, upcoded charges | <a href="https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises">cms.gov/nosurprises</a> | To do  |          | Send itemized-bill request letter; do not pay until reviewed | 2026-06-10 |
| Medical bill disputes | ER visit, balance-billed by out-of-network doctor at in-network hospital | 0            | 0            | No Surprises Act — balance billing for OON ER care is prohibited                                                                                                                                 | <a href="https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises">cms.gov/nosurprises</a> | To do  |          | File No Surprises Act complaint if balance bill confirmed    | 2026-06-10 |

**Note:** Always get the **itemized** bill before paying — that's where duplicate, never-rendered, and upcoded charges hide. (Your right to an itemized bill comes from state law, your insurer's rules, or hospital policy, not a single federal statute — but you can always ask, and most providers will send one.) The No Surprises Act bans balance billing for emergency care and for many out-of-network providers at in-network facilities. File complaints free at the CMS No Surprises Help Desk.

## Section 4 — Bank & card fee reversals

| category                  | item                                                            | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                                      | official free link                                                                | status | deadline   | next action                                                                 | date       |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Bank & card fee reversals | Overdraft fee on a one-time debit purchase I never opted in for | 35.00        | 0            | Regulation E (12 CFR 1005.17) — no overdraft fee on ATM/one-time debit without affirmative opt-in | <a href="https://consumerfinance.gov/complaint">consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a> | To do  |            | Call bank; if no opt-in on file, demand reversal; CFPB complaint if refused | 2026-06-10 |
| Bank & card fee reversals | Unauthorized debit-card charge                                  | 89.00        | 0            | Reg E / EFTA — report within 60 days of statement; bank investigates within 10 business days      | <a href="https://consumerfinance.gov/complaint">consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a> | To do  | 2026-08-09 | Notify bank in writing within 60 days of statement date                     | 2026-06-10 |
| Bank & card fee reversals | Paid for goods on credit card, never delivered                  | 220.00       | 0            | Fair Credit Billing Act (15 USC 1666) — dispute within 60 days of statement                       | <a href="https://consumerfinance.gov/complaint">consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a> | To do  | 2026-08-09 | Send FCBA written dispute to card issuer's billing-inquiries address        | 2026-06-10 |

**Note:** Deadlines here are real and short. Debit disputes (Reg E) and credit billing-error disputes (FCBA) both run **60 days from the statement date** — log that date in the deadline column the moment you spot the charge.

## Section 5 — Subscriptions

| category      | item                                                 | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                                                   | official free link                                                                | status | deadline | next action                                                                  | date       |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Subscriptions | Streaming service charged 3 months after I cancelled | 47.97        | 0            | State auto-renewal laws; Reg E for debit / FCBA for card — dispute as unauthorized if billed post-cancellation | <a href="https://consumerfinance.gov/complaint">consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a> | To do  |          | Gather cancellation confirmation; request refund; dispute on card if refused | 2026-06-10 |

| category      | item                                     | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                        | official free link  | status | deadline | next action                                                      | date       |
|---------------|------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Subscriptions | Free trial auto-converted with no notice | 19.99        | 0            | State automatic-renewal statutes (e.g., CA ARL) require clear consent + easy cancel | reportfraud.ftc.gov | To do  |          | Request refund citing no renewal notice; report to FTC if denied | 2026-06-10 |

**Note:** The FTC's federal "Click-to-Cancel" rule was **vacated by the Eighth Circuit in July 2025**, so don't cite it as binding. Lean on **state auto-renewal laws** and on disputing the charge through your bank (Reg E) or card issuer (FCBA) when a charge hits after you cancelled. Report deceptive subscriptions free at ReportFraud.ftc.gov.

## Section 6 — Tax credits

| category    | item                                                   | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                                                                                            | official free link                  | status | deadline   | next action                                                              | date       |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Tax credits | Qualified for EITC in 2023 but didn't claim it         | 1200.00      | 0            | Earned Income Tax Credit; amend via Form 1040-X. Refund window: 3 yrs from filing / 2 yrs from payment (IRC § 6511)                                     | irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x | To do  | 2027-04-15 | Confirm EITC eligibility; file 1040-X for 2023 (window closes ~Apr 2027) | 2026-06-10 |
| Tax credits | Never filed 2024 — had withholding, likely refund owed | 0            | 0            | Unfiled-year refund: the original return IS the refund claim; file within 3 yrs of the original due date or the refund is forfeited (IRC §§ 6511, 6513) | irs.gov/refunds                     | To do  | 2028-04-15 | File the 2024 return — refund window closes ~Apr 15, 2028                | 2026-06-10 |
| Tax credits | Eligible for Saver's Credit, didn't claim              | 0            | 0            | Retirement Savings Contributions Credit (Form 8880); amend via 1040-X                                                                                   | irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x | To do  |            | Check Form 8880 eligibility; amend if qualified                          | 2026-06-10 |

**Note:** The refund clock is hard. You generally must file Form 1040-X (or, for a year you never filed, the original return — which itself counts as your refund claim) within **3 years of the original filing deadline** to get the money. For wage-withholding refunds the IRS treats the tax as paid on that April 15 due date, so don't let the 3-year line pass — after it, the refund is gone for good. Put the *original due date* + 3 years in the deadline column. (Example: an unfiled 2024 return, due April 15, 2025, must be filed by about April 15, 2028.)

## Section 7 — Warranty / lemon

| category         | item                                                 | potential \$ | recovered \$ | law / source                                                                                                 | official free link  | status | deadline | next action                                                       | date       |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Warranty / lemon | Laptop failed inside warranty, maker refusing repair | 950.00       | 0            | Magnuson-Moss Warranty Act (15 USC 2301) — federal warranty enforcement; bars disclaiming implied warranties | reportfraud.ftc.gov | To do  |          | Send written warranty-claim demand citing Magnuson-Moss           | 2026-06-10 |
| Warranty / lemon | New car, same defect 4 repair attempts               | 0            | 0            | State lemon law + Magnuson-Moss; implied warranty of merchantability (UCC 2-314)                             | reportfraud.ftc.gov | To do  |          | Document all repair orders; send lemon-law demand to manufacturer | 2026-06-10 |

**Note:** The **Magnuson-Moss Warranty Act** is the federal backstop for warranty claims and lets a prevailing consumer recover attorney's fees. State **lemon laws** add stronger remedies for vehicles. Keep every repair order — dates and attempt counts are the whole case. Report deceptive warranty practices free at ReportFraud.ftc.gov.

## Putting it together

In Google Sheets, give each section its own **tab** but keep identical column headers, then total across tabs on a dashboard tab. In Notion, keep everything in **one database** with a **category** property and make a filtered view per section. Setup steps for both are in 03-setup-google-sheets.md and 04-setup-notion.md.



### 03 — Set This Up in Google Sheets (step by step)

**When/how to use this:** Follow this once to build your tracker in Google Sheets. Total time ~15 minutes. You'll import the ready-made 02-master-tracker.csv, then add a dashboard tab with totals and deadline alerts. No add-ons, no paid tools.

**What backs it:** Nothing legal here — this is pure setup. The links inside the imported file all route to free official sources (see 05-official-free-links.md).

#### Part A — Import the tracker (5 minutes)

1. Go to **sheets.google.com** → **Blank spreadsheet**.
2. Rename it (top-left): Money You're Owed — Master Tracker.
3. **File** → **Import** → **Upload** → select 02-master-tracker.csv.
4. In the import dialog choose: - **Import location:** *Replace current sheet* - **Separator type:** *Comma* - **Convert text to numbers / dates:** *Yes* - Click **Import data**.
5. You now have one sheet with all rows. Rename this tab (double-click the tab at the bottom) to All Claims.

#### Part B — Make the headers usable (2 minutes)

1. Click row **1**, then **View** → **Freeze** → **1 row** so headers stay visible when you scroll.
2. Select the header row → **Bold** it and give it a fill color.
3. Format the money columns as currency: - Click column **C** header (potential\_dollars), Ctrl-click column **D** (recovered\_dollars). - **Format** → **Number** → **Currency**. The stored value stays a number; only the display shows \$.
4. Format the date columns: - Select column **H** (deadline) and column **J** (date). - **Format** → **Number** → **Date**.

#### Part C — Add per-section views with a filter (3 minutes)

You don't need seven separate tabs in Sheets — a filter does the job.

1. Click any cell in the data → **Data** → **Create a filter**.
2. Click the filter icon on the **category** column header (column A).
3. Check only the section you want to work (e.g., Airline / travel refunds) → **OK**. The sheet now shows just that section. Clear the filter to see everything again.

**If you prefer real tabs:** right-click the All Claims tab → **Duplicate** for each section, rename them, and filter each copy to its own category. Keep identical column headers on every tab so the dashboard formulas in Part D still work — point them at All Claims.

#### Part D — Build the "Money Recovered" dashboard (5 minutes)

1. Click the + at the bottom to add a new tab. Name it Dashboard.
2. Paste these labels into column A and the formulas into column B. (Formulas assume your data tab is named All Claims with data in rows 2 down.)

| Cell | Paste this                                                                                                                        |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A1   | MONEY RECOVERED DASHBOARD                                                                                                         |
| A3   | Total potential (still open)                                                                                                      |
| B3   | =SUMIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "<>Recovered", 'All Claims'!C2:C) - SUMIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Closed – no recovery", 'All Claims'!C2:C) |
| A4   | Total recovered (money in)                                                                                                        |
| B4   | =SUM('All Claims'!D2:D)                                                                                                           |
| A5   | Total potential (all rows)                                                                                                        |
| B5   | =SUM('All Claims'!C2:C)                                                                                                           |
| A6   | Recovery rate                                                                                                                     |
| B6   | =IFERROR(B4/B5, 0)                                                                                                                |

| Cell | Paste this                                                                     |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A8   | Claims by status:                                                              |
| A9   | To do                                                                          |
| B9   | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "To do")                                           |
| A10  | Researching                                                                    |
| B10  | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Researching")                                     |
| A11  | Filed                                                                          |
| B11  | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Filed")                                           |
| A12  | Escalated                                                                      |
| B12  | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Escalated")                                       |
| A13  | Recovered                                                                      |
| B13  | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Recovered")                                       |
| A15  | Deadlines inside 14 days                                                       |
| B15  | =COUNTIFS('All Claims'!H2:H, ">="&TODAY(), 'All Claims'!H2:H, "<="&TODAY()+14) |

3. Format **B4**, **B5**, **B3** as currency (**Format** → **Number** → **Currency**) and **B6** as percent (**Format** → **Number** → **Percent**).

## Part E — Color-code deadlines and recovered rows (3 minutes)

1. On the All Claims tab, select the whole data range (e.g., A2:J100).
2. **Format** → **Conditional formatting**.
3. **Rule 1 — done:** *Custom formula is* → =\$G2="Recovered" → fill **green**.
4. **Add another rule — closed:** =\$G2="Closed — no recovery" → fill **gray**.
5. **Add another rule — deadline urgent:** =AND(\$H2>=TODAY(), \$H2<=TODAY()+14) → fill **red/orange**.
6. **Add another rule — overdue:** =AND(\$H2<>"", \$H2<TODAY(), \$G2<>"Recovered", \$G2<>"Closed — no recovery") → fill **dark red, bold**.

## Part F — Daily habit

- Add a row the moment you think of a claim. Status To do.
- When money lands: set **status** to Recovered, type the amount into **recovered dollars**, update **date**.
- Once a week, open Dashboard and work anything in Deadlines inside 14 days.

That's it. One spreadsheet, every claim, one running total of money you've gotten back — all routed through free official sources.

## 04 — Set This Up in Notion (step by step)

**When/how to use this:** Follow this once to build the tracker as a Notion database with per-section views and a "Money Recovered" dashboard. ~15 minutes. Works on the free Notion plan.

**What backs it:** Setup only. The `Official Free` Link values route to free official sources (`05-official-free-links.md`).

### Part A — Import the CSV as a database (3 minutes)

1. In Notion, open the page where you want the tracker.
2. Type `/import` or click **Import** in the left sidebar → **CSV** → upload `02-master-tracker.csv`.
3. Notion creates a new database with all your rows. Rename it `Money You're Owed — Master Tracker`.
4. Switch it to a **Table** view if it isn't already (top-left view switcher).

### Part B — Fix the property types (4 minutes)

Notion imports everything as plain text. Set the right types so filters, sorts, and rollups work. Click each column header → **Edit property** → **Type**:

| Property           | Set type to            | Notes                                          |
|--------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| category           | Select                 | Notion auto-creates an option per section name |
| item               | Title                  | Make this the title property (drag it first)   |
| potential_dollars  | Number → Format Dollar |                                                |
| recovered_dollars  | Number → Format Dollar |                                                |
| law_source         | Text                   |                                                |
| official_free_link | URL                    | Makes links clickable                          |
| status             | Status (or Select)     | Recreate the six statuses below                |
| deadline           | Date                   |                                                |
| next_action        | Text                   |                                                |
| date               | Date                   |                                                |

For the **status** property, create exactly these options (color them To-do / In-progress / Complete groups): `To do`, `Researching`, `Filed`, `Escalated`, `Recovered`, `Closed — no recovery`.

### Part C — Per-section views (3 minutes)

You keep everything in ONE database and make a filtered **view** per section.

1. Next to your table view name, click **+ Add view** → **Table** → name it `Unclaimed property`.
2. **Filter** → **category** → **is** → **Unclaimed property**.
3. Repeat for each of the seven sections. Now you have one tab per section across the top, all reading from the same data.
4. Add one more view called `By deadline: Table`, no category filter, **Sort** → **deadline** → **Ascending**, and **Filter** → **status** → **is not** → **Recovered** and **is not** → **Closed — no recovery**. This is your daily worklist.

### Part D — "Money Recovered" dashboard (5 minutes)

Notion can total a number column at the bottom of any view, and you can surface those totals on a dashboard with a linked view.

**Quick version (built-in sums):** 1. In your main table view, scroll to the bottom of the `recovered_dollars` column → click the cell under it → choose **Sum**. That's your running total recovered. 2. Do the same under `potential_dollars` → **Sum** for total potential. 3. Add the calculation to the `By deadline` view too so you see open potential at a glance.

**Dashboard page (cleaner):** 1. Create a new page `Dashboard`. 2. Type `/linked` → **Create linked database** → pick your tracker. 3. Make it a **Board** view grouped by **status** — you instantly see how many claims sit in `To do` / `Filed` / `Recovered`, with a money sum under each column. 4. Add a second linked view, **Table**, filtered to `status = Recovered`, with `recovered_dollars` summed at the bottom = total money you've

gotten back. 5. Add a third linked view filtered to deadlines within 14 days: **Filter** → **deadline** → **is within** → **the next week** (or use a relative date filter) and **status is not Recovered**.

**Optional rollup (recovery rate):** Notion can't divide two database-wide sums in a single field without a parent relation, so keep the recovery rate simple — read total recovered (Part D step 1) against total potential (step 2). If you want it automated, mirror the data into Sheets using [06 - dashboard - and - formulas .md](#).

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## Part E — Color and habit

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- Use the **Status** property's built-in colors — Recovered shows green, Escalated shows red automatically on board views.
- Add a row the moment a claim occurs to you (status To do).
- When money lands: switch **status** to Recovered, enter the amount in **recovered\_dollars**, update **date**.
- Open By **deadline** daily; open Dashboard weekly.

One database, seven views, one running total — every link pointing to a free official source.

## 05 — Official Free Source Links (the never-pay-a-finder list)

**When/how to use this:** This is the verified directory of **free, official** places to start every claim in the tracker. When you add a row, copy the matching link into your **official free link** column. Every link below routes to a government, court, or official non-profit channel. **None of them charge you to search or to claim.**

**What backs it:** Each category lists the controlling law or rule and its citation, current as of 2026. Where a rule recently changed, it's flagged so you don't rely on something that isn't in force.

**The one rule that protects you:** if a site asks for a fee — or a *percentage of your money* — to "find," "release," or "expedite" what's yours, it is not the official source. Close it. The links here are the real front doors, and they are free.

### 1. Unclaimed property

**What it covers:** Forgotten bank accounts, uncashed checks, insurance payouts, security/utility deposits, final paychecks, refunds, stocks — money a business couldn't return to you, turned over to your state, and now held in trust for you.

**The law:** Every state has an **Unclaimed Property Act** (escheat law). The state holds the money **in trust for the owner with no expiration** — there is no deadline to claim it.

| Source                                                     | URL                                                                                   | Use it for                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>MissingMoney.com</b> (NAUPA-managed, free, multi-state) | <a href="https://www.missingmoney.com">https://www.missingmoney.com</a>               | The first search. Run your name + maiden name + every state you've lived in.         |
| <b>Unclaimed.org</b> (NAUPA portal — official state map)   | <a href="https://unclaimed.org/search/">https://unclaimed.org/search/</a>             | Jump to each state's own official site, including states not fully on MissingMoney.  |
| <b>USA.gov — unclaimed money guide</b>                     | <a href="https://www.usa.gov/unclaimed-money">https://www.usa.gov/unclaimed-money</a> | Official overview + links to federal sources (pensions, tax refunds, savings bonds). |

**Note:** A few large states (e.g., **California, New York, Pennsylvania**) aren't fully searchable on MissingMoney.com — use the [unclaimed.org](https://unclaimed.org) map to reach their official sites directly. (*NAUPA / unclaimed.org, confirmed 2026.*)

### 2. Airline / travel refunds

**What it covers:** Cash refunds when an airline **cancels or significantly changes** a flight and you decline rebooking; refunds of bag fees for **significantly delayed** checked bags; refunds for paid services not provided (Wi-Fi, seat selection).

**The law:** The **U.S. DOT automatic-refund rule** — final rule effective 2024, **in force and enforced in 2026** (Refunds and Other Consumer Protections, **14 CFR Part 260**; passenger protections, 14 CFR Part 259). A "**significant change**" = a schedule change of **more than 3 hours domestic / 6 hours international**, a changed departure/arrival airport, added connections, or a downgrade. Refunds must be **automatic, prompt, full, and in the original form of payment** — within **7 business days** for credit-card purchases, **20 calendar days** for cash/check. Separately, the DOT **24-hour rule** lets you cancel any ticket within 24 hours of booking for a full refund if you booked **7+ days** before departure.

| Source                                  | URL                                                                                                   | Use it for                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>DOT air travel complaint form</b>    | <a href="https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint">https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint</a> | File free when an airline stalls or denies a refund you're owed.  |
| <b>DOT Aviation Consumer Protection</b> | <a href="https://www.transportation.gov/airconsumer">https://www.transportation.gov/airconsumer</a>   | Your rights, the refund rule, and the link to the complaint form. |

**Note:** Always request the cash refund **in writing first**. If the airline pushes a voucher or goes silent, file the DOT complaint — airlines must respond to DOT consumer complaints. The core rule (3-hour domestic / 6-hour international thresholds and the refund timelines) is fully in force and enforced in 2026; one narrow piece — where an airline cancels a flight but keeps operating the same route under a different flight number — is under a temporary DOT enforcement pause through **June 30, 2026** while the definition is re-drafted. (*DOT final rule "Refunds and Other Consumer Protections," eff. Oct. 28, 2024; eCFR 14 CFR Part 259/260; DOT enforcement guidance — confirmed in force 2026.*)

### 3. Medical bill disputes

**What it covers:** Itemized-bill requests, duplicate/never-rendered/upcoded charges, and **surprise out-of-network balance bills** for emergency care or for out-of-network providers treating you at an in-network facility.

**The law:** The **No Surprises Act** (effective 2022) bans balance billing for most emergency services and for many out-of-network providers at in-network facilities, and gives you a **Good Faith Estimate** if you're uninsured/self-pay.

| Source                       | URL                                                                                                 | Use it for                                                                            |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CMS No Surprises Help Desk   | <a href="https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises">https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises</a>                       | File a free complaint about a surprise/balance bill; request the Good Faith Estimate. |
| No Surprises Help Desk phone | 1-800-985-3059                                                                                      | Same complaint process by phone.                                                      |
| CFPB complaint portal        | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/</a> | If a medical bill was sent to collections or is hurting your credit report.           |
| Your state Attorney General  | <a href="https://www.naag.org/find-my-ag/">https://www.naag.org/find-my-ag/</a>                     | State-level help with hospital billing and collections.                               |

**Note on credit reports:** The CFPB's January 2025 rule to **remove medical debt from credit reports** was **vacated by a federal court (E.D. Tex., July 11, 2025) and is not in force**. So medical debt can still appear on federal credit reports — though the three bureaus *voluntarily* exclude paid medical debt, unpaid balances under \$500, and debts less than a year old, and a growing list of states (CA, CO, CT, IL, NY, and others) ban it under their own laws. You can still dispute an *inaccurate* medical debt for free via the CFPB and the credit bureaus — but don't assume medical debt is automatically off your report. (*Cornerstone Credit Union League v. CFPB, E.D. Tex., July 11, 2025; bureau voluntary policies; state statutes — confirmed 2026.*)

#### 4. Bank & card fee reversals

**What it covers:** Overdraft/NSF fees you never opted into, unauthorized charges, double charges, and goods/services paid by card but never delivered.

**The law:** - **Fair Credit Billing Act (FCBA)** — credit-card billing errors. Cite **15 U.S.C. § 1666 / Regulation Z, 12 C.F.R. § 1026.13**. You must dispute **in writing within 60 days** of the statement that showed the error; the issuer must **acknowledge within 30 days** and **resolve within two billing cycles (no more than 90 days)**. - **Electronic Fund Transfer Act (EFTA) / Regulation E** — debit-card and bank-account errors. Cite **15 U.S.C. § 1693f / 12 C.F.R. § 1005.11**. Notify within **60 days** of the statement; the bank generally has **10 business days** to investigate (longer only if it provisionally credits you). - **Reg E opt-in rule, 12 C.F.R. § 1005.17** — no overdraft fee on ATM or one-time debit transactions without your **affirmative opt-in**.

| Source                          | URL                                                                                                                                     | Use it for                                                                |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CFPB complaint portal           | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/</a>                                     | File free when a bank or card issuer refuses a valid reversal or dispute. |
| CFPB — disputing a charge guide | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/consumer-tools/credit-cards/">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/consumer-tools/credit-cards/</a> | How FCBA disputes work, step by step.                                     |

**Note:** These deadlines are short and they start from the **statement date**, not the day you noticed. Log that date in your tracker's **deadline** column the moment you spot the charge. (*CFPB / Reg Z § 1026.13, Reg E § 1005.11, confirmed 2026.*)

#### 5. Subscriptions

**What it covers:** Charges after you cancelled, free trials that converted with no notice, and "zombie" subscriptions you can't easily cancel.

**The law (read this carefully — it changed in 2025):** - The FTC **"Click-to-Cancel" rule** (the amended Negative Option Rule) was **vacated by the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Eighth Circuit in July 2025** and is **NOT in force in 2026**. Do not rely on it. - What is enforceable: **state automatic-renewal laws**. California's **Automatic Renewal Law (Cal. Bus. & Prof. Code §§ 17600–17606)** and **New York's** (Gen. Bus. Law §§ 527 et seq.) require clear renewal terms, affirmative consent, and an **easy online way to cancel** a subscription you signed up for online. - For a charge that hit **after** you cancelled, treat it as a billing error / unauthorized charge and use your **FCBA** (credit) or **Reg E** (debit) rights from Section 4.

| Source          | URL                                                                   | Use it for                                                             |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FTC ReportFraud | <a href="https://reportfraud.ftc.gov">https://reportfraud.ftc.gov</a> | Report deceptive subscriptions / trials that converted without notice. |

| Source                      | URL                                                                                                 | Use it for                                                        |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Your state Attorney General | <a href="https://www.naag.org/find-my-ag/">https://www.naag.org/find-my-ag/</a>                     | Enforce your state's auto-renewal law (CA, NY and many others).   |
| CFPB complaint portal       | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/</a> | Dispute a post-cancellation charge through your card issuer/bank. |

**Note:** Keep your **cancellation confirmation** (email, screenshot, confirmation number). That single piece of proof turns "they kept billing me" into a winnable chargeback. (*8th Cir. vacatur of FTC Negative Option Rule, July 2025; CA ARL §§ 17600–17606; NY GBL §§ 527 et seq., confirmed 2026.*)

## 6. Tax credits & refunds

**What it covers:** Credits you qualified for but never claimed (EITC, Child Tax Credit, Saver's Credit, education credits) and refunds from years you didn't file.

**The law:** The **refund statute of limitations, IRC § 6511** — you generally must file a refund claim (an amended **Form 1040-X**, or an original return for an unfiled year — the return itself counts as the claim) within **3 years of the original filing deadline, or 2 years from when the tax was paid, whichever is later**. For wage-withholding refunds, IRC § 6513 treats the tax as paid on the April 15 due date, so the practical line is **3 years from that original due date**. Miss the window and the refund is forfeited to the Treasury.

| Source                                        | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Use it for                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| IRS EITC Assistant<br>(free eligibility tool) | <a href="https://apps.irs.gov/app/eitc">https://apps.irs.gov/app/eitc</a>                                                                                                                                                                               | Check if you qualified for the Earned Income Tax Credit (current or prior year).                                                                 |
| IRS Where's My Refund                         | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/refunds">https://www.irs.gov/refunds</a>                                                                                                                                                                                   | Track a filed refund; confirm one is owed.                                                                                                       |
| About Form 1040-X (amend a return)            | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x">https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x</a>                                                                                                                                           | Claim a credit you missed on a prior return.                                                                                                     |
| IRS Free File                                 | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/filing/free-file-do-your-federal-taxes-for-free">https://www.irs.gov/filing/free-file-do-your-federal-taxes-for-free</a>                                                                                                   | File or amend for free if under the income threshold (Free File partners; the IRS's own Direct File pilot was discontinued for the 2026 season). |
| Child Tax Credit                              | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/credits-deductions/individuals/child-tax-credit">https://www.irs.gov/credits-deductions/individuals/child-tax-credit</a>                                                                                                   | Confirm CTC eligibility and amount.                                                                                                              |
| Saver's Credit (Form 8880)                    | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/retirement-plans/plan-participant-employee/retirement-savings-contributions-credit-savers-credit">https://www.irs.gov/retirement-plans/plan-participant-employee/retirement-savings-contributions-credit-savers-credit</a> | Check the retirement-savings credit.                                                                                                             |

**Note:** The 3-year clock is hard and unforgiving. The day you identify a missed credit or unfiled year, put the **original due date + 3 years** in your tracker's deadline column. (*IRC §§ 6511, 6513; IRS Free File and tools confirmed live for the 2026 filing season; Direct File discontinued for 2026.*)

## 7. Warranty / lemon

**What it covers:** Warranty claims a manufacturer is refusing, repeated repairs of the same defect, and vehicles that qualify as "lemons."

**The law:** - **Magnuson-Moss Warranty Act, 15 U.S.C. §§ 2301–2312** — the federal warranty statute. It requires written warranties to be honored as written, restricts disclaiming **implied warranties** while a written warranty is in effect, and lets a **prevailing consumer recover attorney's fees**. - **Implied warranty of merchantability, UCC § 2-314** — adopted in every state; goods must be fit for their ordinary purpose. - **State lemon laws** — vehicle-specific, stronger remedies (replacement or refund) after a **reasonable number of repair attempts** (often 3–4 for the same defect, or a set number of days out of service). Examples: California **Song-Beverly Act (Cal. Civ. Code §§ 1793.2 et seq.)**, New York **New Car Lemon Law (N.Y. Gen. Bus. Law §§ 198-a et seq.)**.

| Source                         | URL                                                                                                     | Use it for                                             |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| FTC ReportFraud                | <a href="https://reportfraud.ftc.gov">https://reportfraud.ftc.gov</a>                                   | Report a manufacturer refusing a valid warranty claim. |
| FTC consumer warranty guidance | <a href="https://consumer.ftc.gov/articles/warranties">https://consumer.ftc.gov/articles/warranties</a> | Your warranty rights under Magnuson-Moss.              |
| Your state Attorney General    | <a href="https://www.naag.org/find-my-ag/">https://www.naag.org/find-my-ag/</a>                         | File a lemon-law claim or warranty complaint.          |

**Note:** Your whole case is the **paper trail**. Keep every repair order with dates and the defect described — the attempt count is what triggers lemon-law rights. (*Magnuson-Moss 15 U.S.C. §§ 2301–2312; UCC § 2-314; state lemon laws, confirmed in force 2026.*)

### Quick reference — one link per category

| Category                  | Start here (free, official)                                                                           |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Unclaimed property        | <a href="https://www.missingmoney.com">https://www.missingmoney.com</a>                               |
| Airline / travel refunds  | <a href="https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint">https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint</a> |
| Medical bill disputes     | <a href="https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises">https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises</a>                         |
| Bank & card fee reversals | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint/</a>   |
| Subscriptions             | <a href="https://reportfraud.ftc.gov">https://reportfraud.ftc.gov</a>                                 |
| Tax credits & refunds     | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/refunds">https://www.irs.gov/refunds</a>                                 |
| Warranty / lemon          | <a href="https://reportfraud.ftc.gov">https://reportfraud.ftc.gov</a>                                 |

Every one of these is free. That's the whole promise.



## 06 — "Money Recovered" Dashboard & Formulas

**When/how to use this:** Build this once after you've imported the tracker (`02-master-tracker.csv`). It turns your list of claims into a live scoreboard: how much is on the table, how much you've actually gotten back, your recovery rate, and what's about to hit a deadline. Copy-paste the formulas — they're written to drop straight into Google Sheets or Excel.

**What backs it:** Setup only, no legal content. The dashboard reads the same data your free-source links feed into.

### The dashboard concept

Three numbers tell the whole story:

1. **Potential still open** — money you've identified but haven't recovered yet. This is your to-do list, in dollars.
2. **Total recovered** — money actually back in your pocket. This is the number that makes the tracker worth keeping.
3. **Recovery rate** — recovered ÷ everything you ever pursued. It keeps you honest about which categories are worth your time.

Add two operational counts — **claims by status** and **deadlines inside 14 days** — and you have a one-screen command center.

### Setup assumptions

- Your data lives on a tab named **All Claims** (Google Sheets) or sheet **All Claims** (Excel).
- Columns are in the imported order: A category · B item · C potential\_dollars · D recovered\_dollars · E law\_source · F official\_free\_link · G status · H deadline · I next\_action · J date
- Data starts in **row 2**. Use whole-column ranges (C2:C) in Sheets; in Excel use a generous fixed range (C2:C1000).

### Google Sheets formulas

Create a tab named **Dashboard**. Put the labels in column A and the formulas in column B.

| Cell   | Label (col A)                   | Formula (col B)                                                                                           |
|--------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Row 1  | MONEY RECOVERED DASHBOARD       | —                                                                                                         |
| Row 3  | Total potential – still open    | =SUMIFS('All Claims'!C2:C, 'All Claims'!G2:G, "<>Recovered", 'All Claims'!G2:G, "<>Closed – no recovery") |
| Row 4  | Total recovered (money in)      | =SUM('All Claims'!D2:D)                                                                                   |
| Row 5  | Total potential – all rows ever | =SUM('All Claims'!C2:C)                                                                                   |
| Row 6  | Recovery rate                   | =IFERROR(B4/B5, 0)                                                                                        |
| Row 8  | CLAIMS BY STATUS                | —                                                                                                         |
| Row 9  | To do                           | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "To do")                                                                      |
| Row 10 | Researching                     | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Researching")                                                                |
| Row 11 | Filed                           | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Filed")                                                                      |
| Row 12 | Escalated                       | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Escalated")                                                                  |
| Row 13 | Recovered                       | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Recovered")                                                                  |
| Row 14 | Closed – no recovery            | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G, "Closed – no recovery")                                                       |

| Cell   | Label (col A)                  | Formula (col B)                                                                                                                                   |
|--------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Row 16 | Deadlines inside 14 days       | =COUNTIFS('All Claims'!H2:H, ">="&TODAY(), 'All Claims'!H2:H, "<="&TODAY()+14)                                                                    |
| Row 17 | OVERDUE (open + past deadline) | =COUNTIFS('All Claims'!H2:H, "<"&TODAY(), 'All Claims'!H2:H, "<>", 'All Claims'!G2:G, "<>Recovered", 'All Claims'!G2:G, "<>Closed – no recovery") |

Format: B3, B4, B5 as **Currency**; B6 as **Percent**.

### Per-category recovered total (Google Sheets)

To see which category is paying off, add a small breakdown:

| Cell | Label                     | Formula                                           |
|------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A20  | RECOVERED BY CATEGORY     | —                                                 |
| A21  | Unclaimed property        | =SUMIF('All Claims'!A2:A, A21, 'All Claims'!D2:D) |
| A22  | Airline / travel refunds  | =SUMIF('All Claims'!A2:A, A22, 'All Claims'!D2:D) |
| A23  | Medical bill disputes     | =SUMIF('All Claims'!A2:A, A23, 'All Claims'!D2:D) |
| A24  | Bank & card fee reversals | =SUMIF('All Claims'!A2:A, A24, 'All Claims'!D2:D) |
| A25  | Subscriptions             | =SUMIF('All Claims'!A2:A, A25, 'All Claims'!D2:D) |
| A26  | Tax credits               | =SUMIF('All Claims'!A2:A, A26, 'All Claims'!D2:D) |
| A27  | Warranty / lemon          | =SUMIF('All Claims'!A2:A, A27, 'All Claims'!D2:D) |

Put each formula in column B next to its label. The label text in column A must match the category value exactly, so the SUMIF keys off it.

### Excel formulas

Same logic; switch whole-column ranges to fixed ranges and the em dash to a plain hyphen if your status text uses one.

| Cell | Label                        | Formula                                                                                                           |
|------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| B3   | Total potential — still open | =SUMIFS('All Claims'!C2:C1000,'All Claims'!G2:G1000,"<>Recovered",'All Claims'!G2:G1000,"<>Closed - no recovery") |
| B4   | Total recovered              | =SUM('All Claims'!D2:D1000)                                                                                       |
| B5   | Total potential — all rows   | =SUM('All Claims'!C2:C1000)                                                                                       |
| B6   | Recovery rate                | =IFERROR(B4/B5,0)                                                                                                 |
| B9   | To do count                  | =COUNTIF('All Claims'!G2:G1000,"To do")                                                                           |
| B16  | Deadlines inside 14 days     | =COUNTIFS('All Claims'!H2:H1000,">="&TODAY(),'All Claims'!H2:H1000,"<="&TODAY()+14)                               |

If you used the em dash – in the Closed – no recovery status, keep it identical in the formula. The simplest fix across tools: standardize your status text to a plain hyphen Closed - no recovery and match it everywhere.

### Conditional formatting (both tools)

Apply to the data range on All Claims (e.g., A2:J1000). Rules, in order:

1. **Recovered** → **green**: custom formula =`$G2="Recovered"`
2. **Closed** → **gray**: =`$G2="Closed – no recovery"`
3. **Deadline within 14 days** → **orange**: =`AND($H2>=TODAY(), $H2<=TODAY()+14)`
4. **Overdue & still open** → **dark red bold**: =`AND($H2<>"", $H2<TODAY(), $G2<>"Recovered", $G2<>"Closed – no recovery")`

Order matters — Sheets applies the first matching rule, so put "Recovered/Closed" above the deadline rules so a recovered row doesn't also flash red.

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## Notion equivalent

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Notion can't divide two database-wide sums in one field, so keep it visual instead of computed:

- **Board view grouped by status** → each column footer shows a **Sum of recovered\_dollars**. You see To do / Filed / Recovered with dollars under each.
  - **Table view filtered to status = Recovered** → footer **Sum of recovered\_dollars** = total money in.
  - **Table view, deadline is within the next week, status is not Recovered** = your urgent list.
  - For a true recovery *rate*, mirror the data into Sheets and use the formula above. (Full Notion steps: 04-setup-notion.md.)
- 

## Reading the dashboard

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- **Potential still open** going up = you're finding money. Good.
- **Total recovered** going up = you're collecting it. Better.
- **Recovery rate** below ~40% over time = you're logging claims you never finish. Work the By deadline view and either recover or Closed — no recovery each stale row.
- **Deadlines inside 14 days > 0** = do those first. Refund and tax windows don't reopen.

One screen, every dollar, all of it routed through free official sources.

## 02 Master Tracker (importable spreadsheet)

This table is also provided as an editable .csv you can import into Google Sheets, Excel, or Notion.

| category                  | item                                                                     | potential_dollars | recovered_dollars | law_source                                                                                                                                                                  | official_free_link                                                                                    | status | deadline |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------|
| Unclaimed property        | Old checking account, First Regional Bank, closed ~2018                  | 240.00            | 0                 | State unclaimed property act (escheat) - held in trust for owner, no expiration                                                                                             | <a href="https://missingmoney.com">https://missingmoney.com</a>                                       | To do  |          |
| Unclaimed property        | Uncashed final paycheck, prior employer                                  | 0                 | 0                 | State unclaimed property act                                                                                                                                                | <a href="https://unclaimed.org/search">https://unclaimed.org/search</a>                               | To do  |          |
| Unclaimed property        | CA-held funds (lived in LA 2015-2019)                                    | 0                 | 0                 | CA Unclaimed Property Law                                                                                                                                                   | <a href="https://www.sco.ca.gov/upd_msg.html">https://www.sco.ca.gov/upd_msg.html</a>                 | To do  |          |
| Airline / travel refunds  | Flight cancelled, airline only offered a voucher                         | 412.00            | 0                 | DOT automatic refund rule, 14 CFR Part 260 - cash refund owed when flight cancelled/significantly changed and you decline rebooking                                         | <a href="https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint">https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint</a> | To do  |          |
| Airline / travel refunds  | 3+ hour domestic delay, didn't fly                                       | 0                 | 0                 | DOT rule: 3-hr domestic / 6-hr intl delay = significant change -> refund if you decline travel                                                                              | <a href="https://www.transportation.gov/airconsumer">https://www.transportation.gov/airconsumer</a>   | To do  |          |
| Airline / travel refunds  | Checked bag delayed >12 hrs, paid bag fee                                | 35.00             | 0                 | DOT rule - bag fee refund for significantly delayed checked bag                                                                                                             | <a href="https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint">https://secure.dot.gov/air-travel-complaint</a> | To do  |          |
| Medical bill disputes     | Hospital bill, no itemization, suspect duplicate charges                 | 1840.00           | 0                 | Request an itemized bill (right varies by state/payer/hospital policy - no single universal federal itemized-bill law); review for duplicate/never-rendered/upcoded charges | <a href="https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises">https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises</a>                         | To do  |          |
| Medical bill disputes     | ER visit, balance-billed by out-of-network doctor at in-network hospital | 0                 | 0                 | No Surprises Act - balance billing for OON ER care is prohibited                                                                                                            | <a href="https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises">https://www.cms.gov/nosurprises</a>                         | To do  |          |
| Bank & card fee reversals | Overdraft fee on a one-time debit purchase I                             | 35.00             | 0                 | Regulation E (12 CFR 1005.17) - no overdraft fee on ATM/one-time debit                                                                                                      | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a>     | To do  |          |

| category                  | item                                                   | potential_dollars | recovered_dollars | law_source                                                                                                                              | official_free_link                                                                                            | status | deadline   |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------|
|                           | never opted in for                                     |                   |                   | without affirmative opt-in                                                                                                              |                                                                                                               |        |            |
| Bank & card fee reversals | Unauthorized debit-card charge                         | 89.00             | 0                 | Reg E / EFTA - report within 60 days of statement; bank investigates within 10 business days                                            | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a>             | To do  | 2026-08-09 |
| Bank & card fee reversals | Paid for goods on credit card, never delivered         | 220.00            | 0                 | Fair Credit Billing Act (15 USC 1666) - dispute within 60 days of statement                                                             | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a>             | To do  | 2026-08-09 |
| Subscriptions             | Streaming service charged 3 months after I cancelled   | 47.97             | 0                 | State auto-renewal laws; Reg E for debit / FCBA for card - dispute as unauthorized if billed post-cancellation                          | <a href="https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint">https://www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint</a>             | To do  |            |
| Subscriptions             | Free trial auto-converted with no notice               | 19.99             | 0                 | State automatic-renewal statutes (e.g. CAARL) require clear consent + easy cancel                                                       | <a href="https://reportfraud.ftc.gov">https://reportfraud.ftc.gov</a>                                         | To do  |            |
| Tax credits               | Qualified for EITC in 2023 but didn't claim it         | 1200.00           | 0                 | Earned Income Tax Credit; amend via Form 1040-X. Refund window: 3 yrs from filing / 2 yrs from payment (IRC 6511)                       | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x">https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x</a> | To do  | 2027-04-15 |
| Tax credits               | Never filed 2024 - had withholding, likely refund owed | 0                 | 0                 | Unfiled-year refund: original return IS the refund claim; file within 3 yrs of original due date or refund is forfeited (IRC 6511/6513) | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/refunds">https://www.irs.gov/refunds</a>                                         | To do  | 2028-04-15 |
| Tax credits               | Eligible for Saver's Credit, didn't claim              | 0                 | 0                 | Retirement Savings Contributions Credit (Form 8880); amend via 1040-X                                                                   | <a href="https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x">https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-1040x</a> | To do  |            |
| Warranty / lemon          | Laptop failed inside warranty, maker refusing repair   | 950.00            | 0                 | Magnuson-Moss Warranty Act (15 USC 2301) - federal warranty enforcement; bars disclaiming implied warranties                            | <a href="https://reportfraud.ftc.gov">https://reportfraud.ftc.gov</a>                                         | To do  |            |
| Warranty / lemon          | New car, same defect 4 repair attempts                 | 0                 | 0                 | State lemon law + Magnuson-Moss; implied warranty of merchantability (UCC 2-314)                                                        | <a href="https://reportfraud.ftc.gov">https://reportfraud.ftc.gov</a>                                         | To do  |            |